

Book II - The Spiral and the Block

Part 2 - The Mythology of Media

Chapter 21 - Nothing Is True, Everything Is Permitted

NOTHING IS TRUE, EVERYTHING IS PERMITTED

The Living Age | Mythology of Media — Assassin's Creed | ~9-10 min

There is a creed that has been misunderstood for decades.

Four words that sound like nihilism — like the absence of meaning, the abolition of morality, the permission to do anything.

Nothing is true. Everything is permitted.

Most people hear that and think — chaos.

The Templars hear it and think — exactly. This is why we need control.

But that is not what it means.

It never was.

The Assassin Brotherhood has existed across every era of human history.

Ancient Egypt. Classical Greece. Viking Scandinavia. Renaissance Italy. Ottoman Constantinople. Colonial America. Revolutionary France.

Every culture. Every tradition. Every era.

And in every one — the same creed.

Not the same language. Not the same customs. Not the same weapons or tactics or gods.

The same creed.

Because the creed was never about uniformity.

It was about alignment with something deeper than any culture could contain.

Altaïr Ibn-La'Ahad was a Syrian. A Muslim. A man formed by the traditions of the medieval Middle East.

Ezio Auditore was an Italian. A Renaissance man. Formed by art and politics and the Church and the streets of Florence.

Connor Kenway was half Mohawk, half British — carrying two worlds inside him, belonging fully to neither, serving something larger than both.

Bayek of Siwa was Egyptian — his creed formed by the gods of the Nile, by love for his son, by grief that became purpose.

Eivor was Norse — a shield-maiden shaped by the sagas, by Odin's shadow, by the cold of a world that demanded strength.

Every one of them different.

Every one of them the same body.

Paul wrote it two thousand years before the Brotherhood existed in myth:

"Just as a body, though one, has many parts, but all its many parts form one body — so it is with the creed."

The eye cannot say to the hand — *I don't need you.*

Altaïr cannot say to Eivor — *your tradition doesn't belong here.*

The diversity is not a weakness to be managed.

It is the design.

Now look at the Templars.

They are not evil in the way villains are usually evil.

They do not want suffering. They do not want chaos.

They want order.

They look at human beings — flawed, violent, self-destructive, easily manipulated — and they reach the same conclusion in every era:

People cannot govern themselves. They need to be guided.

And they are not entirely wrong about the observation.

People do make destructive choices. Societies do collapse into violence. The Block does offer something the Spiral cannot always provide — the appearance of stability.

But the Templar makes the oldest mistake of every empire:

They confuse the symptom with the cause.

Human beings are not destructive because they are free.

They are destructive when they are cut off from the living order — when the creed written on their conscience is suppressed, when they are managed instead of cultivated, when they are treated as machines to be controlled rather than living things to be stewarded.

The Templar's solution — the Pieces of Eden, the systems of control, the overriding of free will — does not heal the wound.

It deepens it.

Because you cannot produce living order by taking away the living thing's ability to choose it.

The Pieces of Eden are the most honest symbol in the whole mythology.

They are not crude weapons.

They are instruments of consent management.

The Apple of Eden doesn't kill. It controls perception. It makes people believe what the holder wants them to believe. It manufactures consensus.

This is the Block's ultimate tool.

Not the sword — the sword is too visible, too costly, too likely to produce resistance.

The narrative.

The controlled story.

The managed reality that makes submission feel like freedom and the cage feel like home.

Whoever controls the Apple controls the dream.

And whoever controls the dream controls everything.

The Assassins do not want to rule.

This is what distinguishes them from every other faction in the mythology.

They do not want the Apple for themselves. They do not want to replace the Templar order with their own order.

They want to destroy the Apple.

Because they understand something the Templars never will:

You cannot cultivate a living thing by controlling it.

You can only create the conditions for it to flourish on its own terms.

The Assassin is not the gardener who tells each plant where to grow.

The Assassin is the one who keeps the bulldozer away from the garden.

They work in the dark.

They serve the light.

Not their light. Not their version of the right order.

The light.

The living order that was always already there — in every culture, every tradition, every conscience — waiting for the space to emerge.

Nothing is true.

No worldly authority is absolute. No empire, no pope, no institution, no Apple holds ultimate truth. Every human system is provisional. Every throne is temporary. Every law written by men can be rewritten by men.

Everything is permitted.

Therefore conscience governs. The higher law supersedes every earthly law. When the institution demands what the living order forbids — you answer to the living order.

Not as license. As obligation.

This is not nihilism.

This is the most rigorous moral position possible.

It removes every excuse of institutional obedience.

You cannot say — *I was following orders.*

You cannot say — *the system required it.*

You answer to something higher than the system.

And that something is not nothing.

It is the law written on every heart before any institution existed to claim authority over it.

We must obey God rather than men.

Peter said it. Tertullian said it. John Wise said it.

The Assassins have been saying it since ancient Egypt.

Paul looked at the early church and saw what the Templars could never build and the Assassins always carried.

A body.

Not an institution. Not a hierarchy. Not a senate of approved beliefs.

A living organism — many members, one body, each part different, each part necessary, each part following the same living code written into it by its Creator.

"The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I don't need you.' And the head cannot say to the feet, 'I don't need you.' On the contrary, those parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."

The Templar looks at diversity and sees chaos to be managed.

The body looks at diversity and sees design.

The foot is not a failed hand.

The Norse Assassin is not a failed Italian Assassin.

The Muslim tradition is not a failed Christian tradition.

They are different members of the same body — each carrying a piece of the living order that the others need, each expressing the same creed through the unique form of their own existence.

The creed does not demand that you become someone else.

It demands that you become fully yourself — aligned with the living order written into your nature — and trust that the body knows what to do with what you offer.

The Templars will always exist.

Because the fear that drives them will always exist — the fear of human chaos, the fear of freedom, the fear of a living order that cannot be predicted or controlled.

And they will always offer the same thing.

Order. Purpose. Direction.

The Apple. The Piece of Eden. The managed dream.

And it will always look reasonable.

[beat]

The Assassins will always exist too.

Because the creed written on every human conscience cannot be fully suppressed.

It re-emerges. In every era. In every culture. In people who have never heard of the Brotherhood but who feel — in their bones, in their conscience, in the part of them that knows — that no earthly authority has the final claim on their soul.

Nothing is true.

No throne. No empire. No institution.

Everything is permitted.

Follow the living order. Follow the law written on your heart. Follow the creed — not because an organization gave it to you, but because it was always already there.

[pause]

We work in the dark to serve the light.

Not our light.

The light.

And we are many members.

One body.

[OUTRO — music up, channel name card]

THE LIVING AGE *Civilization as a Living System A Spiral Steward Project*

Production Notes

- **On-camera segments:** Cold open (~40 sec) + close (~100 sec)
- **The creed misreading:** The cold open pivot — most people hear nihilism, you reveal the opposite. This is the hook that keeps people watching.
- **The Templars are sympathetic:** Do not make them cartoons. They are the most honest villains because their diagnosis is partially correct. The video is stronger when you acknowledge that.
- **The Pieces of Eden = narrative control:** This is the line that connects to today without naming today. Let the viewer make the connection themselves.
- **"The foot is not a failed hand"** — the emotional heart of the video. Let it land.
- **"We work in the dark to serve the light. Not our light. The light."** — closing image. The distinction between serving your own agenda and serving the living order.
- **Music:** Open sparse. Build through the Templar section — slightly ominous. Shift to warmth at the body/1 Corinthians section. Full warmth on the close.
- **Word count:** ~1,300 words spoken. At easy pace: 10 minutes.
- **Stock footage keywords:** Assassin's Creed game footage/stills, ancient world landscapes, Renaissance Italy, Viking Norway, Egypt, body anatomy illustration, cells dividing, diverse people in community, hidden blade reveal, leap of faith

The Living Age Trilogy